

OPTIMISATION

HiFi Checklist

01

Is the mains phase set correctly?

Tip: Use a phase detector and plug in all devices with the correct polarity.

☐ YES ☐ NO

02

Are the speakers positioned correctly (relative to the listener)?

Tip: Optimal placement: an equilateral triangle between the speakers and the listening position. Speakers should not be placed too close to the wall - keep a minimum distance of 30-50 cm.

☐ YES ☐ NO

03

Could the left and right channels be swapped?

Tip: Turn the balance control fully to the left and play the left audio track (test signal), then check whether only the left speaker is active. If you hear no sound, the right and left channels are probably swapped.

☐ YES ☐ NO

04

Are all HiFi devices connected to one power strip or to several different sockets?

Tip: Recommendation: run all devices from a single high-quality, filtered power strip or from a power regenerator (mains conditioner).

☐ YES ☐ NO

05

How long are the cables between the HiFi devices?

Tip: Shorter cables = less capacitance and interference. Optimal: 0.5 - 1.5 m for RCA. Analogue connections (from 3 m) should generally be made using an XLR connection, as it is less sensitive to interference. Please note: cables can act like antennas and feed unwanted RF interference into the HiFi system.

☐ YES ☐ NO

06

Is there a tangle of cables behind the HiFi system?

Tip: Power and signal cables should not touch or cross each other (electromagnetic interference).

☐ YES ☐ NO

07

When and how were the contacts last cleaned?

Tip: Clean contacts with isopropanol and then treat them with contact fluid.

☐ YES ☐ NO

08

Are the pre- and power amplifiers stacked directly on top of each other?

Tip: Devices should stand separately or be decoupled with HiFi bases (heat, vibrations). Ideally the preamplifier should sit at the top and the power amplifier at the bottom of the rack - the radiation from the power amp's transformer can audibly affect the sensitive preamplifier.

☐ YES ☐ NO

09

What do your HiFi devices stand on?

Tip: Prefer solid, low-resonance furniture. Avoid glass or wood with strong self-resonance. There are special HiFi racks that are particularly stable and low-resonance by design, offering measurable sonic advantages over conventional furniture.

☐ YES ☐ NO

10

Do you use a HiFi base under your devices?

Tip: Device bases and absorber feet decouple from the surface and reduce structure-borne noise.

☐ YES ☐ NO

11

Do you use a mains filter or a power regenerator for your HiFi system?

Tip: A high-quality mains filter noticeably reduces RF interference from the power grid. A power regenerator goes one step further: it completely converts the mains current and generates a new, clean sine wave - the result is a significantly purer power supply for your HiFi system.

☐ YES ☐ NO

12

How strong is the electromagnetic radiation (phones, WiFi, etc.) in your music room?

Tip: Remove WiFi routers and mobile devices from the listening room where possible, or switch them off.

☐ YES ☐ NO

13

Are all RCA / XLR / HDMI / COAX inputs and outputs sealed?

Tip: Fit unused inputs and outputs with terminating caps - this protects against dust and RF interference.

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YES

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NO

14

Do you use standard HiFi fuses in your devices?

Tip: High-quality HiFi fuses (e.g. Furutech, Synergistic Research) are made of pure silver or copper and have gold-plated contacts - this reduces resistance and can lead to better dynamics, more detail resolution, deeper bass and lower noise. Important: always use the same amperage and trip characteristic (T = slow-blow, F = fast-blow).

☐

YES

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NO

15

Are your speakers properly decoupled from the floor?

Tip: Speakers can be decoupled from the floor using a stone slab and/or spikes or special absorbers. The right type of decoupling can have a major influence on the sound.

☐

YES

☐

NO